

Zac Owen

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Research-driven brand and marketing leader with 8+ years of in-house and agency experience creating and communicating customer-focused brand narratives. Proven ability to lead extensive qualitative and quantitative research, translate findings into actionable insights, and convey them clearly to internal and external stakeholders. Trusted relationship builder and project manager with experience leading integrated, multi-channel campaigns that are consistent, strategically grounded, and designed to resonate across every touchpoint.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Brand Strategist

August 2024 – Present

Click Control Marketing — Lansing, MI (Hybrid)

- Serve as the agency's brand strategy lead, analyzing qualitative and quantitative customer data to inform executive-level recommendations across business, brand, and marketing strategy.
- Run strategy sessions with business owners and C-suite leaders, presenting insights from customer interviews, focus groups, surveys, and market research.
- Provide creative and messaging oversight across marketing channels, reviewing campaigns for brand alignment and directing revisions needed to meet brand standards.
- Led end-to-end brand development and launch for a \$12M+ restaurant concept for a global hotel brand, including stakeholder and customer interviews, naming and logo development, and multi-channel launch.
- Led U.S. market-entry strategy for a Netherlands-based global coffee equipment manufacturer—aligned Netherlands and U.S. executives, conducted market research, defined positioning and unique selling positions, activated an integrated go-to-market plan across marketing and sales.
- Led communications strategy for the last-minute cancellation of a promised brand launch, maintaining zero negative sentiment while driving 11x higher social media engagement with 30% follower growth.
- Owned and scaled the agency's branding offering 8x into a significant revenue driver; pitching, landing, and delivering projects with consistent client satisfaction.
- Built a high-trust partnership with a white-label client and led growth strategy and process improvements that scaled the account 4x within one year, making it the agency's largest account.

Brand Manager

March 2022 – May 2024

The Motley Fool — Denver, CO (Hybrid)

- Served as the voice of the customer, leading primary and secondary research to improve brand perception.
- Directed a cross-functional team of 10 to design and execute trust research (25+ interviews; 10 surveys), analyze findings, and present insights to leadership and a 500+ person organization.
- Facilitated insight workshops with 15+ teams to activate findings through integrated marketing and product touchpoint improvements, increasing trust perceptions by 18 points across four key areas within one year.
- Led a cross-functional group of 16 to improve the customer email experience using journey mapping and targeted fixes, resulting in a 22-point increase in member satisfaction within six months.

- Launched and led an ongoing testimonial initiative—interviewed 50+ customers and integrated stories into marketing and sales emails, supporting 60% customer satisfaction rates.
- Managed creative development with in-house designers and copywriters across web, social, email, podcast, and programming; partnered with Legal/Compliance to secure approvals.
- Ideated and executed a member loyalty initiative delivering 1,000+ personalized handwritten thank-you cards; managed budget and influenced \$1.2M in revenue.

Marketing Editor

September 2021 – March 2022

The Motley Fool – Denver, CO (Hybrid)

- Partnered with Product Marketing and Member Marketing to launch 20+ campaigns, ensuring consistent messaging and disciplined execution across channels.
- Synthesized customer feedback and data from surveys, social media insights, and customer service interactions to provide actionable, customer-focused recommendations.

Public Relations Specialist

August 2019 – September 2021

The Motley Fool – Denver, CO (Hybrid)

- Crafted and pitched data-driven story ideas to reporters, securing 100+ earned placements and high-authority backlinks, including coverage in The New York Times, HuffPost, and Fortune.
- Developed press materials (press releases, talking points, and pitches) and strengthened media relationships to support launches and ongoing brand visibility.
- Led an SEO research initiative featuring expertise from influencers and professors that reached the #1 Google ranking for “credit cards,” driving significant website traffic and revenue.

Content Marketing Intern

June 2017 – August 2019

PaySimple – Denver, CO (Hybrid)

- Contributed to a full rebrand with external agency partners, strengthening brand identity across channels.
- Drove 204% blog traffic growth and 4x lead generation by applying SEO and content best practices.
- Managed all social media channels (LinkedIn, X, Facebook, Instagram), creating and publishing content.

Skills & Tools:

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| • Brand Strategy & Marketing Strategy | • Strategic Planning & Execution |
| • Brand Management & Brand Marketing | • Market Research and Customer Research |
| • Go-to-Market (GTM) Strategy & Launch | • Project Management |
| • Integrated Marketing Campaigns | • Quantitative & Qualitative Analysis |
| • Agency & Vendor Management | • ROI Analysis and Budget Management |
| • Executive Communication & Presentation | • Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) |
| • Cross-Functional Leadership | • Google Analytics Tableau Qualtrics |
| • Performance Measurement (KPIs) | • Monday.com Salesforce |

Metropolitan State University

Denver, CO – Bachelor of Science, Marketing

- Honor Society Member
- 2x NCAA Division II Football Conference Champion